

Grade 3 Ontario Curriculum Spatial Sense

Fencing the Farm — Grade 3 Measurement

Unit Overview: Fencing the Farm — Grade 3 Measurement

Grade: Grade 3 | **Strand:** Spatial Sense

Target Expectations: E2.1, E2.2, E2.3, E2.4, E2.5, E2.6, E2.7, E2.8, E2.9

Learning Goal: Children will measure perimeter, area, capacity, mass, and time using appropriate units and tools.

Lesson	Lesson Title	Learning Goal
Day 1	Fence the Farm (Perimeter)	I can measure perimeter and pick the right metric unit.
Day 2	Compare Areas	I can compare areas of shapes by matching or covering.
Day 3	Square Centimetres	I can measure area in square centimetres and square metres.
Day 4	Capacity and Mass	I can measure capacity and mass with non-standard units.
Day 5	Time and Big Farm Capstone	I can tell time and pick the right measurement tool.

Lesson 1: Fence the Farm (Perimeter)

Goal: PERIMETER is the distance AROUND a shape. Pick mm, cm, m, or km depending on size.

Expectation: E2.1, E2.2

Learning Goal: "I can measure perimeter and pick the right metric unit."

Materials: M1_polygon_set, M2_unit_chart, M7_measurement_chart, M10_unit_poster

1. Minds On (12 mins): Roo's Farm Fence

Roo the Ruler Rabbit: Farmer Phil needs FENCES around 4 fields. The PERIMETER tells him how much fence to buy! Roo opens: 'WALK AROUND, ADD the SIDES — that's PERIMETER!'

Bring children to the carpet. Roo the Ruler Rabbit puppet. 'Measurement friends — last year we measured LENGTHS in cm and m. This year we measure all the way AROUND a shape — that's PERIMETER!'

2. Action (25 mins): Measure 4 Perimeters

- Hand out Polygon Cards + ruler.
- For each, write the unit (mm/cm/m/km).
- Stretch: construct a rectangle with perimeter 20 cm.
- Help with addition strategy — column or in-pairs.
- Circulate to record diagnostic.
- INVENT-AND-COMPARE: Pairs find perimeter of a hexagon (6 sides of 2 cm) ANY way.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Roo's Fence Brag

Discuss:

- What's PERIMETER?
- Which unit for a bug?
- How many cm in 1 m?
- Same perimeter — different shape?
- Roo's preview: tomorrow we COMPARE AREAS (Lesson 2 — E2.1).

Exit: Roo's perimeter chant — 'WALK AROUND, ADD the SIDES — that's PERIMETER!' (3x).

Lesson 2: Compare Areas

Goal: AREA is the SPACE INSIDE a shape. Compare by MATCHING, COVERING, or DECOMPOSING.

Expectation: E2.7, E2.8

Learning Goal: "I can compare areas of shapes by matching or covering."

Materials: M3_tile_set, M7_measurement_chart, M10_unit_poster

1. Minds On (12 mins): Roo's Tile Cover

Roo: AREA is HOW MUCH space is INSIDE. Cover the field with tiles to compare! Roo opens: 'ROWS times COLUMNS — that's AREA!' Yesterday Roo did the BOUNDARY. Today we cover the INSIDE.

Bring children to the carpet. Roo the Ruler Rabbit puppet. 'Measurement friends — yesterday we measured AROUND. Today we measure INSIDE — that's AREA!'

2. Action (25 mins): Cover and Compare 4 Shapes

- Hand out shape outlines + 30 tiles.
- Compare 2 pairs of shapes — which has bigger area?
- Stretch: decompose 1 shape into smaller parts and recompose.
- Help with edge-to-edge tile placement.
- Circulate to record formative.
- STRATEGY COMPARE: Two pairs share their area methods — Pair A counts one-by-one; Pair B uses rows $\times$ columns.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Roo's Cover Brag

Discuss:

- What's AREA?
- How is area DIFFERENT from perimeter?
- What if tiles OVERLAP?
- Can 2 shapes have the same area?

Exit: Roo's area chant — 'Roo says: ROWS times COLUMNS — that's AREA!' (3x).

Lesson 3: Square Centimetres

Goal: AREA is measured in SQUARE UNITS — cm^2 for small, m^2 for big.

Expectation: E2.9

Learning Goal: "I can measure area in square centimetres and square metres."

Materials: M3_tile_set, M9_grid_paper, M7_measurement_chart, M10_unit_poster

1. Minds On (12 mins): Roo's Square Centimetres

Roo: AREA needs a UNIT. We use SQUARE CENTIMETRES (cm^2). Count them inside! Roo opens: ' cm^2 is a TILE — count the TILES!'

Bring children to the carpet. Roo the Ruler Rabbit puppet with grid paper. 'Measurement friends — yesterday we covered with tiles. Today our tile is OFFICIAL: $1\text{ cm} \times 1\text{ cm} = 1\text{ SQUARE CENTIMETRE} = \text{cm}^2$.'

2. Action (25 mins): Count cm^2 for 4 Shapes

- Hand out grid paper + shapes.
- For 2 shapes pick cm^2 or m^2 .
- Stretch: count cm^2 for 1 curved shape (whole + half squares).
- Help with grid alignment.
- Circulate to record formative.
- STRATEGY COMPARE: Two pairs share L-shape area — one decomposes into two rectangles, one counts tiles.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Roo's Square Brag

Discuss:

- What's a SQUARE CENTIMETRE?
- When use m^2 instead of cm^2 ?
- How count for a CIRCLE?
- Why ESTIMATE first?

Exit: Roo's cm^2 chant — 'Roo says: cm^2 is a TILE — count the TILES!' (3x).

Lesson 4: Capacity and Mass

Goal: CAPACITY = how much it HOLDS. MASS = how HEAVY. Different units = different counts.

Expectation: E2.3, E2.4, E2.5

Learning Goal: "I can measure capacity and mass with non-standard units."

Materials: M4_balance_card, M8_capacity_set, M7_measurement_chart, M10_unit_poster

1. Minds On (12 mins): Cal's Pour and Weigh

Cal: CAPACITY tells how much a cup HOLDS. MASS tells how HEAVY a pumpkin is. Pour and weigh! Roo opens: 'CAPACITY for what FITS, MASS for what WEIGHS!'

Bring children to the carpet. Cal the Calendar Cat puppet with stopwatch. 'Measurement friends — today we measure how much HOLDS (capacity) and how HEAVY (mass).'

2. Action (25 mins): Capacity and Mass Stations

- Hand out Capacity Cards.
- Hand out Pan Balance Cards.
- Stretch: same pail, count in cups AND in scoops.
- Help with the unit-size relationship.
- Circulate to record formative.
- STRATEGY COMPARE: Pairs predict the cup-to-scoop count for a NEW pail BEFORE pouring, then test.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Cal's Measure Brag

Discuss:

- What's CAPACITY?
- What's MASS?
- Why does cup count differ from scoop count?
- What's an OVERFILL?

Exit: Roo+Cal mass+capacity refrain — 'Roo measures CAPACITY, Cal weighs MASS — same NUMBER, different ATTRIBUTE!' (3x).

Lesson 5: Time and Big Farm Capstone

Goal: TELL TIME in hours, minutes, seconds. Use the right TOOL for each measurement.

Expectation: E2.6

Learning Goal: "I can tell time and pick the right measurement tool."

Materials: M1_polygon_set, M3_tile_set, M4_balance_card, M5_clock_set

1. Minds On (12 mins): Cal's Clock Time

Cal: TIME on analog and digital clocks. Today's BIG case — perimeter, area, capacity/mass, and TIME! Roo + Cal open: 'Measure AROUND, measure the FILL, measure the TIME!'

Bring children to the carpet. Roo and Cal puppets in farmer hats. 'Friends — today is our CAPSTONE. Last 4 days we did perimeter, area, area in cm^2 , capacity and mass. Today we add TIME!'

2. Action (25 mins): The Big Farm

- Hand out templates.
- Stations 1-4: perimeter, area, capacity/mass, time.
- Stretch: write a 'farmer's brag' — one sentence per station.
- Help with clock reading at Station 4.
- Circulate to record summative evidence.
- STRATEGY COMPARE at perimeter station: pause at minute 15.

3. Consolidation (13 mins): Roo and Cal's Big Farm Brag

Discuss:

- What's PERIMETER vs AREA?
- When use cm^2 vs m^2 ?
- What's CAPACITY?
- What's HOURS, MINUTES, SECONDS?

Exit: Roo + Cal capstone refrain — Roo: 'Measure AROUND, measure the FILL!' Cal: 'Measure the TIME!' Class: 'That's MEASUREMENT!' (3x).

Name: _____

Date: _____

Roo's Fence Math

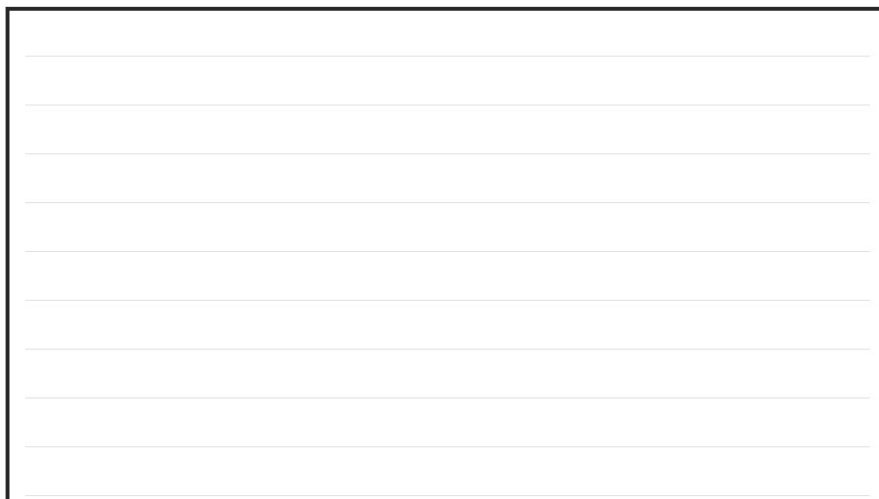
Learning Goal: I can measure perimeter and pick the right metric unit.

Mission

1. For 4 polygons, add up all sides to find the perimeter.
2. For 4 objects, circle the BEST unit: mm, cm, m, or km.
3. Draw a rectangle with perimeter 16 cm.

Part 3: Build a polygon.

Draw a rectangle with perimeter 16 cm. Label sides.

A large rectangular box with a black border, containing ten horizontal grey lines for drawing and labeling a rectangle.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Roo's Tile Compare

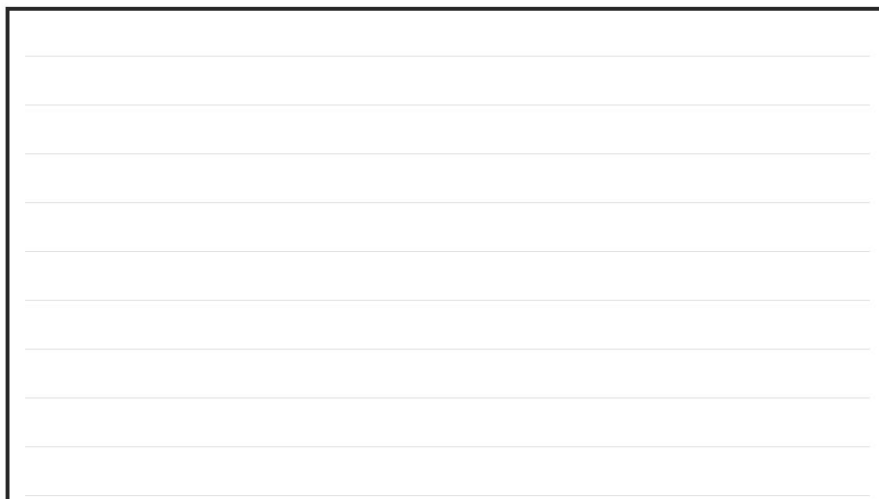
Learning Goal: I can compare areas of shapes by matching or covering.

Mission

1. Count tiles inside 4 shapes.
2. For 2 shape pairs, circle BIGGER, SMALLER, or SAME area.
3. Draw 2 DIFFERENT shapes that have the SAME area (each 6 tiles).

Part 3: Find SAME area.

Draw 2 DIFFERENT shapes that have the SAME area (each 6 tiles).

A large rectangular box with a black border, containing ten horizontal lines for drawing shapes.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Roo's Square Cm Hunt

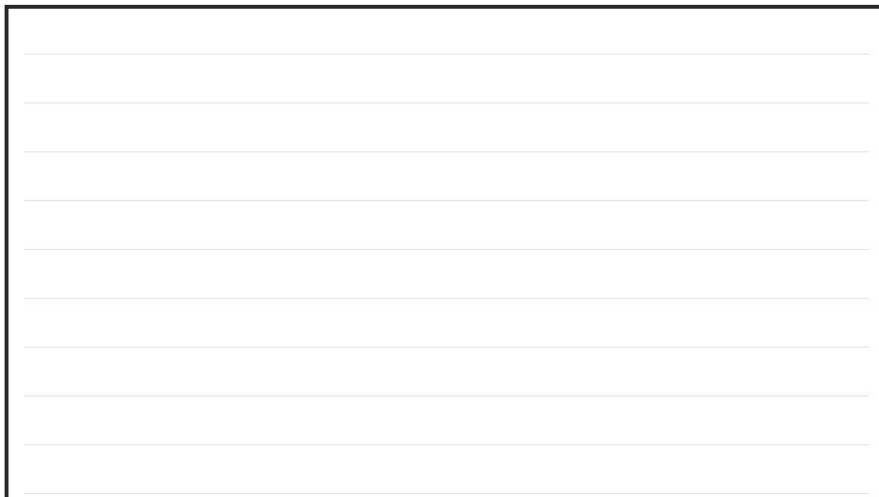
Learning Goal: I can measure area in square centimetres and square metres.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Count cm^2 inside 4 shapes on a grid.
2. For 4 objects, circle the right area unit: cm^2 or m^2 .
3. Estimate the area of the circle on the grid by counting whole + half squares.

Part 3: Estimate a circle.

Estimate the area of the circle on the grid by counting whole + half squares.

A large empty rectangular box with a black border, intended for a student to draw a circle on a grid for area estimation. The box is currently blank.

Date: _____

Learning Goal: I can measure capacity and mass with non-standard units.

1. For 4 container pairs, circle which holds MORE.
2. For 4 pan balance images, write HEAVIER, LIGHTER, or EQUAL.
3. If a pail = 6 cups and 1 cup = 2 scoops, how many SCOOPS?

If a pail = 6 cups and 1 cup = 2 scoops, how many SCOOPS?

[illegible]

Name: _____

Date: _____

Roo and Cal's Big Farm

Learning Goal: I can tell time and pick the right measurement tool.

Instructions for the Student:

1. For 2 shapes, find PERIMETER (cm) and AREA (cm²).
2. Compare 1 capacity pair and 1 mass pair.
3. Read 4 clocks (mix of analog + digital).

Part 2: Capacity and mass.

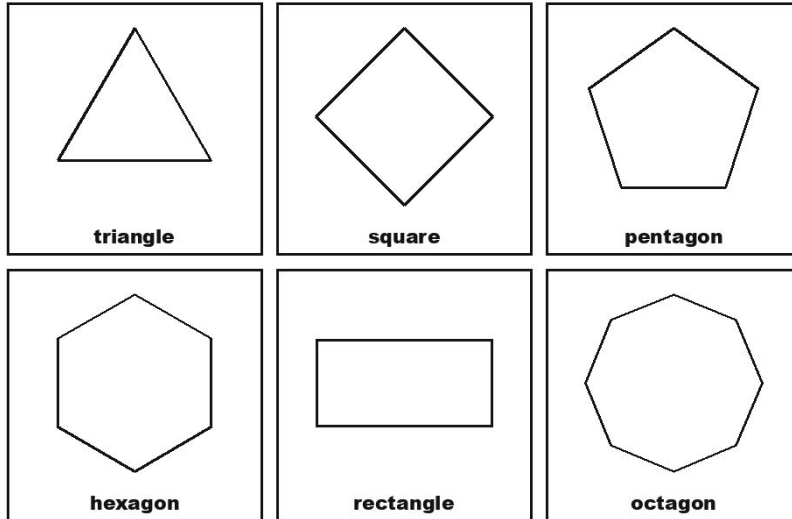
Compare 1 capacity pair and 1 mass pair.

Polygon Cards Set

(M1_polygon_set)

12 paper polygons with side lengths labelled.

Polygon Cards



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Laminate.

3. Cut into 12 cards per set.

4. Store in labelled bag.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 1, 5

Prep: ~25 min

Metric Unit Chart

(M2_unit_chart)

Anchor chart with mm, cm, m, km benchmarks.

Benchmarks

1 cm fingernail	10 cm thumb to pinky
1 m long step	1 g paper clip
100 g stick of butter	1 kg 1 L of water
1 mL drop	1 L milk carton

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Laminate.

3. Tape to front wall before Lesson 1.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 chart

Lessons: 1, 5

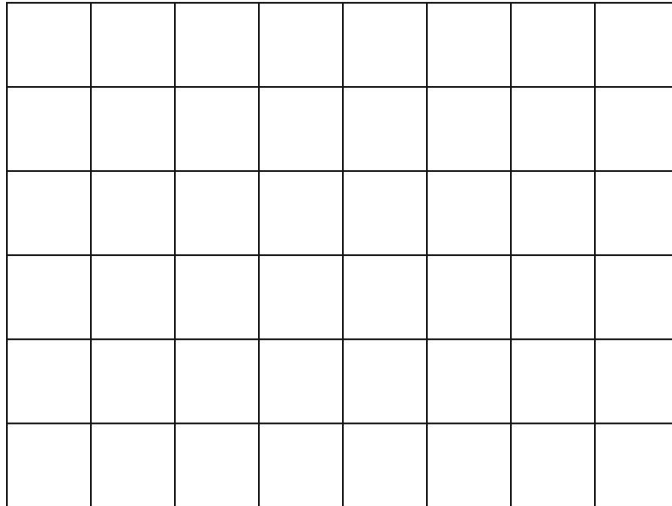
Prep: ~10 min

Square Tiles Set

(M3_tile_set)

60 paper square tiles (1 cm² each).

Area Grid — 8 × 6



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 2

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 5 sets.

2. Laminate.

3. Cut into 60 tiles per set.

4. Store in labelled bag.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 5 sets

Lessons: 2, 3, 5

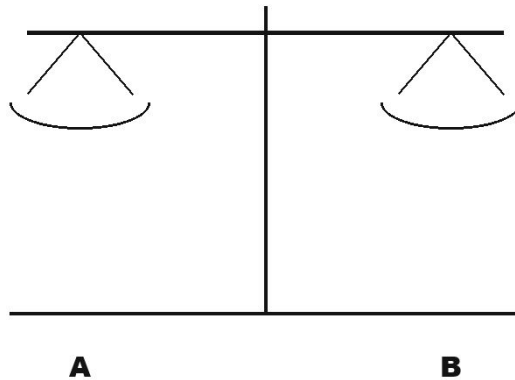
Prep: ~30 min

Pan Balance Cards

(M4_balance_card)

12 paper pan balance cards with weighable items.

Balance Scale



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Laminate.

3. Cut into 12 cards per set.

4. Store in labelled bag.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 4, 5

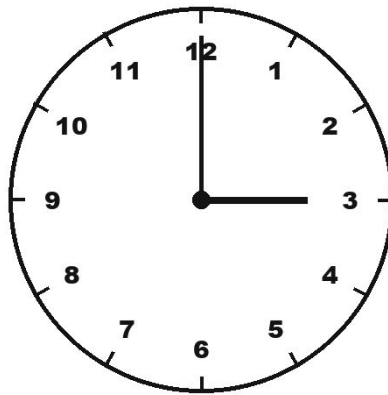
Prep: ~20 min

Analog and Digital Clock Cards

(M5_clock_set)

16 clock cards mixing analog and digital.

Clock — 03:00



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Laminate.

3. Cut into 16 cards per set.

4. Store in labelled bag.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 5

Prep: ~25 min

Big Farm Template

(M6_capstone_template)

Letter-size capstone template with 4 sections.

Big Farm Template	
1	Perimeter _____
2	Area _____
3	Capacity/Mass _____
4	Time _____

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: no

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 25 templates.

2. Stack near teacher table.

3. No lamination.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 25 templates

Lessons: 5

Prep: ~5 min

Measurement Vocabulary Chart

(M7_measurement_chart)

Anchor chart with G3 measurement vocabulary.

Measurement Vocabulary Chart	
Perimeter	Capacity
• Area • Millimetre • Kilometre	• Mass • Square Centimetre • Square Metre

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Laminate.

3. Tape to front wall before Lesson 1.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 chart

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

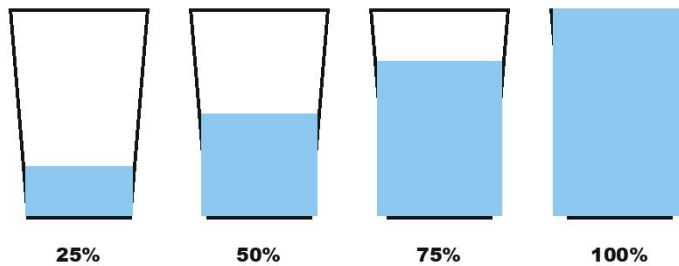
Prep: ~10 min

Capacity Cup Cards

(M8_capacity_set)

20 paper container cards with cup/scoop unit counts.

Cups & Capacity



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets.

2. Laminate.

3. Cut into 20 cards per set.

4. Store in labelled bag.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 4, 5

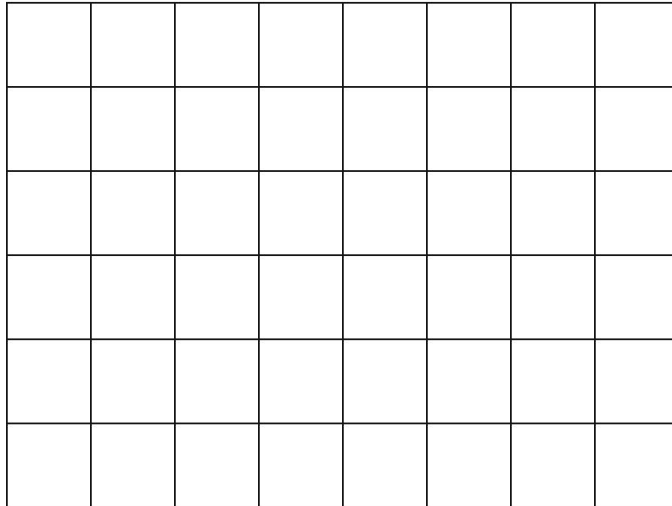
Prep: ~25 min

Cm² Grid Paper

(M9_grid_paper)

Letter-size grid paper with 1 cm × 1 cm squares.

Area Grid — 8 × 6



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 12 sheets.

2. Laminate (optional).

3. Distribute one per pair.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10-12 sheets

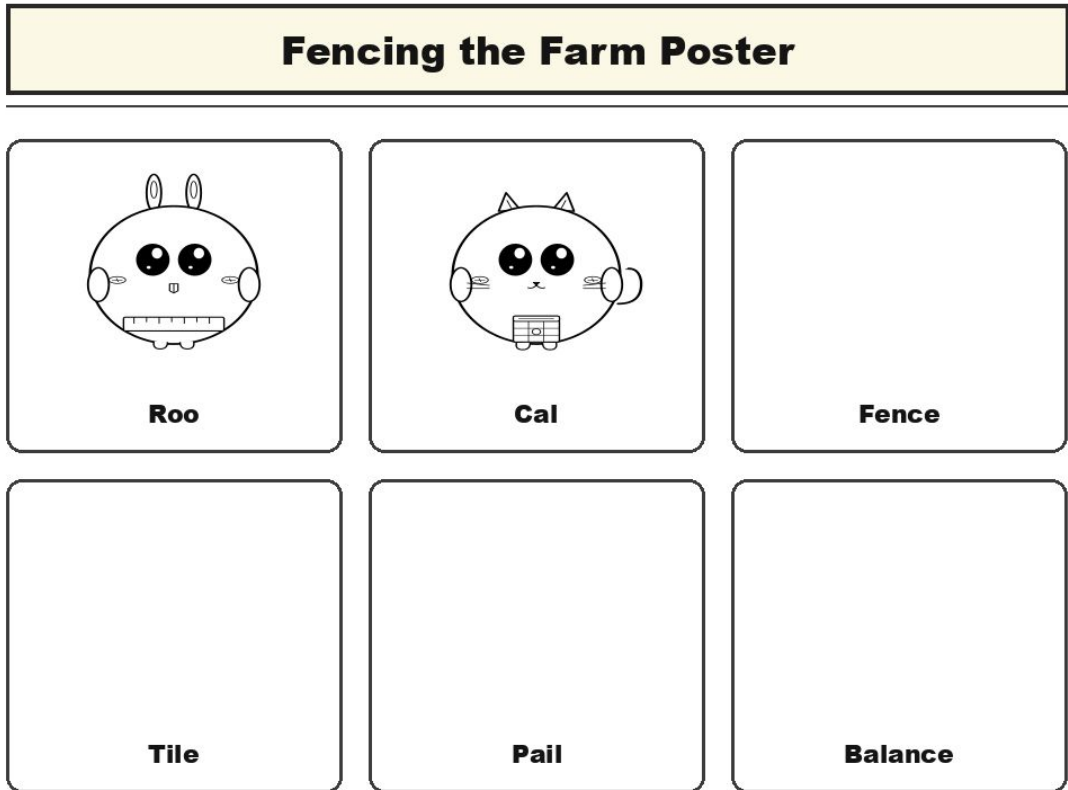
Lessons: 3, 5

Prep: ~10 min

Fencing the Farm Poster

(M10_unit_poster)

Unit anchor poster of Roo and Cal at a farm.



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter landscape

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy on letter or 11x17.

2. Laminate.

3. Tape to front wall on Day 1.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 poster

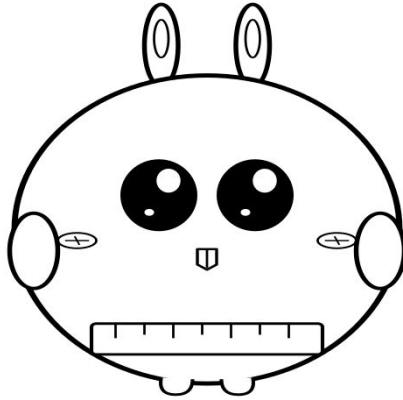
Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

Roo Puppet

(char_roo_puppet)

Paper puppet of Roo the Ruler Rabbit for teacher use in all 5 lessons.



Roo the Ruler Rabbit

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Cut around silhouette and tab.

3. Laminate.

4. Glue popsicle stick.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet

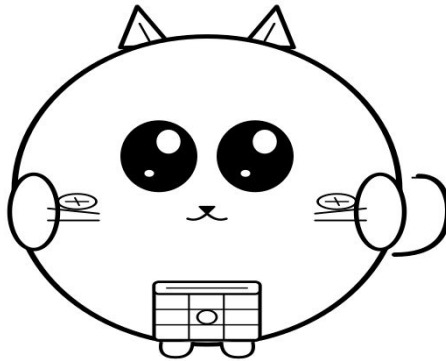
Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~12 min

Cal Puppet

(char_cal_puppet)

Paper puppet of Cal the Calendar Cat for teacher use in Lessons 4-5.



Cal the Calendar Cat

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy.

2. Cut around silhouette and tab.

3. Laminate.

4. Glue popsicle stick.

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet

Lessons: 4, 5

Prep: ~12 min

Name: _____

Date: _____

Summative Assessment Rubric

Expectation	Level 1 (Beginning)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 3 (Achieving)	Level 4 (Exceeding)
E2.1 use appropriate units of length to estimate, measure, and compare the perimeters of	Cannot find perimeter. Adds wrong sides.	Finds perimeter with prompts.	Independently measures perimeter and constructs polygons.	Compares perimeters across shapes and explains.
E2.7 compare the areas of two-dimensional shapes by matching, covering, or decomposing and	Confuses area with perimeter.	Compares areas with prompts.	Independently compares areas by covering or decomposing.	Identifies different shapes with the same area.
E2.9 use square centimetres (cm ²) and square metres (m ²) to estimate, measure, and compare the	Cannot use cm ² . Wrong unit choice.	Counts cm ² with prompts.	Independently counts cm ² and picks cm ² or m ² appropriately.	Estimates curved-shape area with whole + half squares.
E2.3 use non-standard units appropriately to estimate, measure, and compare capacity, and	Cannot compare capacity.	Compares with prompts.	Independently measures and compares capacity with non-standard units.	Explains overflow/underfill effects.
E2.6 use analog and digital clocks and timers to tell time in hours, minutes, and seconds	Confuses hour and minute hands.	Reads analog or digital clock with prompts.	Independently reads analog and digital clocks.	Reads to seconds; converts hours-minutes-seconds.
E2.2 explain the relationships between millimetres, centimetres, metres, and kilometres as	Cannot pick the right unit for the size.	Picks unit with prompts and benchmarks.	Independently picks mm/cm/m/km using benchmarks.	Converts between units (10 mm = 1 cm; 100 cm = 1 m).
E2.4 compare, estimate, and measure the mass of various objects, using a pan balance and	Cannot read pan balance.	Reads heavier or lighter with prompts.	Independently compares mass using a pan balance.	Estimates mass before measuring.
E2.5 use various units of different sizes to measure the same attribute of a given item, and	Thinks different counts mean different attribute.	Recognizes same-attribute with prompts.	Independently shows same attribute under different units.	Articulates inverse relation: bigger unit, fewer counts.
E2.8 use appropriate non-standard units to measure area, and explain the effect that	Tiles with gaps or overlaps without noticing.	Tiles edge-to-edge with prompts.	Independently tiles edge-to-edge and explains gaps/overlaps.	Quantifies gap/overlap error.

Junior Measurer Certificate (G3)

This certificate is proudly presented to:

For successfully completing the 5-Day G3 Fencing the Farm unit and demonstrating the skills of a G3 Junior Measurer. Roo the Ruler Rabbit congratulates the student.

By completing this unit, this student has demonstrated:

- Measuring perimeter and area
- Using cm^2 and m^2 for area
- Comparing capacity and mass
- Reading analog and digital clocks

Marketplace Listing

A 5-day Grade 3 unit on measurement framed around Roo the Ruler Rabbit and Cal the Calendar Cat at Farmer Phil's farm.

Price: \$9.99 CAD

Pages: ~50

Classroom time: 250 min

Teacher prep: ~220 min

Top tags: Grade 3, math, measurement, perimeter, area, capacity, mass, time

What's included:

- Unit blueprint (1 file)
- 5 lesson plans (5 files)
- 5 worksheets (5 files)
- Manipulatives plan (1 file)
- Formative + reflection (1 file)
- Assessment suite (1 file)